

CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA → SA, HYBRID, OR FULLY REMOTE →
UK / EUROPE TIMEZONE-FRIENDLY • BRITISH PASSPORT

ABOUT

SUMMARY

I build AI-powered internal tools, developer productivity systems and platform automations that help engineering teams move faster with more confidence - on DevOps foundations that run in production.

The career arc is intentional: Senior Software Quality Analyst and SDET, then deeper into **DevOps, platform engineering and agentic engineering**, and now building the **AI layer** at scale - PR review automation across hundreds of production repositories (formally recognised by engineering leadership), support tooling that lives where engineers already work, and a metrics layer that gives leadership a real picture of adoption and cost. Alongside the day job: thirteen consumer products built solo - a paid iOS game on the App Store, apps live on iOS and Android, and multi-tenant web apps with real users. The QA roots are why my AI work runs in production, not just in demos.

CAREER ARC

PHASE 01

Software Quality Analyst

Derivco • Durban → Cape Town • 2015 - 2022

Functional, regression, and performance testing across iGaming releases. Mentored junior QA, built CI/CD pipeline test integrations.

PHASE 02

SDET

Derivco • Cape Town • 2022 - 2023

C# / Selenium / PyTest / Playwright test frameworks for iGaming and Backoffice. Pipeline ownership and rapid response.

PHASE 03

Senior SQA

BET Software • Cape Town • 2023 - 2024

QA leadership across multiple products. Test automation strategy, CI/CD efficiency, end-to-end frameworks.

PHASE 04

DevOps + AI Layer

BET Software • Cape Town • 2024 - present

CI/CD modularisation, AI PR review at enterprise scale, support tooling, migration platform. Thirteen solo AI products.

WORK EXPERIENCE

06/2024 - present
CAPE TOWN
CURRENT

Intermediate DevOps Engineer
BET Software

- Implemented modular CI/CD pipelines with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions; significantly improved build and deploy reliability and time.
- Authored PowerShell and Python automation for server health-checks, pipeline automation, and log cleanup - saving approx 40 hrs/month of operational toil.
- Built Ansible playbooks for config management, software deploys, and build-agent cleanup - reducing manual workload by approx 25 hrs/month.
- Hardened Kubernetes build agents with custom Dockerfiles and pipeline configurations; raised operational efficiency and stability.
- Integrated active Dynatrace monitoring into Microsoft Teams for real-time alerts and proactive incident management.
- Curator of the DevOps Confluence space; authored extensive how-to guides and knowledge-sharing articles, reducing onboarding time for graduates and new starters.
- Automated JIRA task and epic workflows - structured creation, transitions, linking, and bulk updates - cutting manual ticketing overhead and keeping engineering work traceable end-to-end.

KEY PROJECTS · AI LAYER + AUTOMATION

- ↳ Designed and rolled out AI-assisted PR reviews across Azure DevOps and GitHub Copilot at hundreds of production repositories - schema-validated output, severity gating, advisory-to-enforced rollout, kill-switch controls, per-review cost telemetry.
- ↳ Built a unified DevOps support toolkit (CLI + REST API), VS Code chat participant, Atlassian assistant, and Kafka AI deployment workflow.
- ↳ Automated a ~3,400-game casino catalog's metadata extraction and uptime verification with Playwright and a locally-hosted vision model - collapsing an estimated 5-7 person-weeks of manual transcription per refresh into 2-3 days unattended, at zero inference cost.
- ↳ Modular CI/CD YAML pipelines with conditional Docker setups and isolated deploys; GitHub Actions → ADO migration with auto-PR rewrite tooling.
- ↳ Fully automated BI & Finance pipelines: dacpac artifacts, server health-checks, test suites, and secure approval gates (the company had none prior).
- ↳ Custom SonarQube reporting pipelines that auto-generate Excel reports and graphs for Head of Software & SLT, auto-committed to ADO via Git.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, GITHUB ACTIONS, PYTHON, POWERSHELL, ANSIBLE, KUBERNETES, DOCKER, ARGOCO, DYNATRACE, SONARQUBE, CONFLUENCE, CLAUDE / OPENAI / ELEVENLABS APIS

06/2023 -
06/2024

CAPE TOWN

1 YR

Senior Software Quality Analyst

BET Software

- ↳ Championed and maintained QA environments across several products.
- ↳ Spearheaded test automation initiatives to enhance CI/CD efficiency and reduce live-issue and deployment risk.
- ↳ Created comprehensive reusable, automatable test packs and aided in the creation of end-to-end testing frameworks covering functional, performance, and integrated security testing.
- ↳ Drove pipeline-integrated quality gates so a green build genuinely meant ready-to-deploy.

STACK: PYTHON, PYTEST, POWERSHELL, POSTMAN, SQL SERVER, AZURE DEVOPS, GIT, DOCKER, ELASTIC, GRAFANA, JIRA, SELENIUM, PLAYWRIGHT, ZENDESK

02/2022 -
07/2023

CAPE TOWN

1.5 YRS

Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET)

Derivco

- ↳ Developed and maintained automated test frameworks for iGaming and Backoffice applications.
- ↳ Implemented and executed test automation using C#, Selenium, PyTest, and Playwright frameworks.
- ↳ Incorporated AI-powered automation strategies to optimise software-testing procedures.
- ↳ Owned build and release pipelines, emphasising reliability and maintainability.
- ↳ Member of the Rapid Response team for production incident triage.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, AZURE TEST PLANS, SELENIUM, JAVASCRIPT, OCTOPUS DEPLOY, OWASP, C#, POWERSHELL, SQL SERVER

11/2015 -
02/2022

DURBAN

6.3 YRS

Software Quality Analyst

Derivco

- ↳ Executed functional, regression, and performance testing for software releases.
- ↳ Conducted performance testing using JMeter and Locust to optimise system efficiency.
- ↳ Improved CI/CD pipeline efficiency through test-automation integration.
- ↳ Facilitated agile processes and mentored junior QA staff.
- ↳ Designed end-to-end CI/CD pipelines automating ephemeral environments in Axiom: web app, backend service, database, and configuration deployment; automated installation of casino games

and back-office software, creation and funding of test user accounts, and execution of integrated test suites - reducing manual overhead substantially.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, POSTMAN, POWERSHELL, SQL SERVER, LAUNCHDARKLY, IIS, VMWARE

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS & SIDE PROJECTS

SOLO WORK

Hadedad Havoc, Fettle, izwi, PowerMeter, ShotKit - thirteen consumer products built solo, several live: a paid arcade game on the iOS App Store, a smart tool-catalog app in TestFlight, a language app on iOS and Android, and multi-tenant web apps. End-to-end ownership: edge architecture, mobile, billing, store deployment, and CI quality gates with Playwright. Real users and real production constraints - the kind of hardening that takes a demo to a live app.

ADO → GitHub migration platform - production-grade, enterprise-scale, open source. Source freezing, parity validation, retryable batches, and audit reports. Built around the parts of migration that demos skip.

AI platform lab - a local-first AI platform run as daily infrastructure on a single 12 GB GPU: quantized local LLMs, Whisper/Kokoro voice, RAG memory over Qdrant, and a least-privilege personal agent with tool allowlists, tiered approvals, and audit trails. Where enterprise AI platform patterns get proven cheaply before they ship at work.

SELECTED TALKS

TALK

System Resilience: Engineering for Reliability - BET Masterclass Episode 3, February 2026. Practical approaches to designing systems that remain reliable under pressure: incident response, observability, and using AI to manage incidents calmly. youtu.be/s-2zqj-200A

SKILLS

CI/CD, INFRASTRUCTURE & SECRETS

Azure DevOps · GitHub Actions · IIS · Kubernetes · Docker · ArgoCD · Octopus Deploy · Helm · Terraform · RHEL OpenShift · HashiCorp Vault

TESTING & QUALITY ENGINEERING

Playwright · Maestro · PyTest · Selenium · Vitest / Jest · Postman · JMeter · Locust · Load / functional / regression / API / mobile / exploratory

MONITORING & OBSERVABILITY

Dynatrace · Grafana · ELK (Elastic) · Datadog · SonarQube

AUTOMATION, SCRIPTING & WORKFLOW

Python · PowerShell · TypeScript / JavaScript · Ansible · YAML · Bash · C# · Microsoft Power Automate · n8n

DOCUMENTATION & COLLABORATION

Confluence (curator of multiple spaces) · JIRA · Agile / SCRUM · Knowledge-base authoring

AI / LLM

Anthropic Claude (API + Vision) · OpenAI · Google · ElevenLabs · HeyGen · Open-weights · Prompt caching · Edge inference · MCP · Agentic workflows

TEST MANAGEMENT & CASE PLATFORMS

Azure Test Plans · Zephyr Scale · Test Rail · JIRA (test workflows + task/epic automation) · Postman Collections · ISTQB-aligned test design

CLOUD & PLATFORMS

Azure · Cloudflare Workers · Windows Server · RHEL OpenShift · Linux administration · VMware vSphere / vCloud

APPLICATION STACKS

FastAPI · React Native · Vite · Tailwind · SQL Server · Kafka

STRENGTHS & OUTSIDE WORK

- ↳ **Outcome-first.** Specific over general. "Hundreds of production repositories" beats "large enterprise estate."
- ↳ **Sustainable engineering.** Automation that compounds over years, not automation that ships once and rots.
- ↳ **Honest about limits.** When the model's wrong, the UI says so. Over-claiming is what makes AI work feel sketchy.
- ↳ **Documentation as a deliverable.** Tools the rest of the team can read, run, and modify.
- ↳ **Mentorship.** A decade of QA leadership taught me that growing the people next to you is the highest-leverage thing you can do.

OUTSIDE WORK

Hiking 🏞️ FPV drones 🚁 Motorcycles 🏍️
Taekwon-do 🥋 Boxing 🥊 Coffee road-trips ☕
Tech & PC gaming 🎮 Agentic coding 🤖

References and recommendations available on LinkedIn or upon request.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

07/2024 - 04/2025	DevOps & Cloud training LinkedIn Learning · KodeKloud Academy
03/2018	ISTQB® Advanced Level Test Analyst SQS · Information Technology, Testing
03/2015	ISTQB® Certified Foundation Level Tester ISEB · Information Technology, Testing
2020	LinkedIn Learning - foundations AI Foundations: Machine Learning · DevOps Foundations: Containers · Git Essential Training · C# Essential Training
2003 - 2006	Bachelor of Arts (BA) - Psychology, Communications, English Varsity College
2002	Matriculated Westville Boys' High School

Thank you for taking the time to read through my CV - I genuinely appreciate it.
I'd welcome a conversation about how my experience could fit your team.

🌐 <https://www.stewart-burton.com>